For internal review

Survey Results on Generative AI Use at Work

All-staff survey results and a review of in-house adoption options

September 30, 2026

Planning Office

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Summary

- (Survey) An anonymous online survey of all 412 staff ran September 8-19, 2026, and 287 responded (response rate 69.7%)
- (Current use) 54.7% of respondents have used generative AI for work, and 51.6% of users use it twice a week or more
- (Gaps in use) Use is low on the shop floor and among older staff, at 22.1% for the Production team and 29.3% for those 50 and over
- (Security) 36 users (22.9%) have entered work documents into external services, and 22 of them knew the rule when they did
- (Perceived benefits) 68.8% of users feel they save 1 hour or more of work a week, but there is no measured evidence
- (Errors) 71.3% of users have received factually wrong answers, and 17 used them in work documents as they were
- (Needs) An in-house service is the top request at 61.3%, followed by training at 51.9%
- (Other companies) Company A, which measured a baseline before its pilot, proved the benefit, while Company B, which allowed full use without guidelines, stopped use within 6 months
- (Adoption option) A security-contract cloud service was assessed as the most realistic option for fit with the security rules and setup time
- (Next steps) Usage guidelines announced in October and the in-house hyperscale AI pilot plan (draft) reported to executives in November

1. Survey overview

1.1 Background

- Since the first half of 2026, many department heads have reported a rise in staff using generative AI on their own
- At the July 2026 management meeting, the CEO asked for a review of whether an in-house hyperscale AI pilot is feasible
- An all-staff survey was run to understand actual use and staff needs before that review
- The current information security rules prohibit entering work documents into external generative AI services, so compliance was checked as well

1.2 Survey design

Item	Details
Purpose	Identify how staff use generative AI at work and what they need, as baseline input for reviewing an in-house hyperscale AI pilot
Population	All 412 staff
Period	September 8-19, 2026 (2 weeks)
Method	Anonymous online survey on the company survey system (23 multiple-choice and 2 open-ended questions)
Responses	287 (response rate 69.7%)
Supplementary research	Interviews with staff at 3 companies in the same industry (August 2026)

1.3 Question structure

Area	Questions	Answered by
Respondent profile	4	All respondents
Current use	4	All respondents for use, users for the rest
Tasks and benefits	6	Users
Security rules	6	Varies by question (see Attachment 1)
Concerns and needs	3	All respondents
Open-ended	2	All respondents

1.4 Notes

- Users are defined as staff who used a generative AI service for work at least once in the past 6 months
- The survey is anonymous and self-reported, so answers were not verified
- Time saved is the respondents' own estimate, not a measured value
- Shares for multiple-answer questions add up to more than 100%
- Shares are rounded to one decimal place, so totals may differ from 100.0%

2. Respondent profile

2.1 Responses by department

- The overall response rate is 69.7%, and every member of the IT team responded
- The Production team has the lowest response rate at 56.6%
- Shift work and shop-floor duties appear to have made it hard for the Production team to take part during working hours

Department	Headcount	Respondents	Response rate	Share of respondents
Quality team	61	48	78.7%	16.7%
Design team	78	62	79.5%	21.6%
Production team	152	86	56.6%	30.0%
Sales team	45	34	75.6%	11.8%
Business Support team	52	39	75.0%	13.6%
IT team	5	5	100.0%	1.7%
Planning Office	19	13	68.4%	4.5%
Total	412	287	69.7%	100.0%

2.2 Responses by rank

Rank	Respondents	Share
Staff	98	34.1%
Assistant manager	72	25.1%
Manager	58	20.2%
Deputy general manager	34	11.8%
General manager and above	25	8.7%

2.3 Responses by age

Age	Respondents	Share
20s	64	22.3%
30s	103	35.9%
40s	79	27.5%
50 and over	41	14.3%

2.4 Responses by years of service

Years of service	Respondents	Share
Under 3 years	71	24.7%
3-10 years	118	41.1%
10 years or more	98	34.1%

- Staff and assistant managers make up more than half of respondents, and people in their 30s are the largest group
- Respondents with 10 years or more of service make up 34.1% of the total

3. Current use

3.1 Overall use

- 157 of 287 respondents (54.7%) said they have used generative AI for work
- There are 130 non-users, and their reasons are covered in section 5.4
- Excluding the Production team, the use rate in office departments is 68.7% (138 of 201)

3.2 Use by department

- Use rates in office departments range from 56.4% to 100.0%, while the Production team stands at only 22.1%
- The Production team's large share of shop-floor work, with little time at work PCs, is the presumed cause
- The IT team and the Planning Office often meet new tools first because of their work, so their use rates are high

Department	Respondents	Users	Use rate
Quality team	48	31	64.6%
Design team	62	45	72.6%
Production team	86	19	22.1%
Sales team	34	24	70.6%
Business Support team	39	22	56.4%
IT team	5	5	100.0%
Planning Office	13	11	84.6%
Total	287	157	54.7%

3.3 Use by rank, age and years of service

- From manager up, the higher the rank, the lower the use rate, down to 32.0% for general managers and above
- The use rate is 73.4% for people in their 20s and 29.3% for those 50 and over, a wide gap between age groups
- The use rate is 73.2% for staff with under 3 years of service and 36.7% for those with 10 years or more
- Managers who make decisions have little experience of use, so a shared sense of the benefits is needed

Rank	Respondents	Users	Use rate
Staff	98	61	62.2%
Assistant manager	72	46	63.9%
Manager	58	29	50.0%
Deputy general manager	34	13	38.2%
General manager and above	25	8	32.0%

Age	Respondents	Users	Use rate
20s	64	47	73.4%
30s	103	66	64.1%
40s	79	32	40.5%
50 and over	41	12	29.3%

Years of service	Respondents	Users	Use rate
Under 3 years	71	52	73.2%
3-10 years	118	69	58.5%
10 years or more	98	36	36.7%

3.4 Frequency of use

- 81 of 157 users (51.6%) use it twice a week or more
- Nearly half of users use it once a week or less, so it has not yet become an everyday work tool
- 59.0% of staff-level users use it twice a week or more, against 37.5% of general managers and above

Frequency	Responses	Share
Daily	23	14.6%
2-3 times a week	58	36.9%
Once a week or less	76	48.4%

Rank	Daily	2-3 times a week	Once a week or less	Twice a week or more
Staff	11	25	25	59.0%
Assistant manager	7	18	21	54.3%
Manager	3	9	17	41.4%
Deputy general manager	1	4	8	38.5%
General manager and above	1	2	5	37.5%

3.5 Services and devices

- Free general-purpose chatbots are the most used, at 77.1%
- Under their terms of use, free services may use input to improve the service, so they carry the greatest security risk
- 26.1% use it mainly on a personal phone, so work content is processed on devices the company cannot manage

Service used (multiple answers)	Responses	Share of users
Free general-purpose chatbot	121	77.1%
AI built into a search engine	58	36.9%
Paid personal subscription	34	21.7%
AI built into document tools	27	17.2%

Main device	Responses	Share
Work PC	104	66.2%
Personal phone	41	26.1%
Personal PC	12	7.6%

4. Tasks

4.1 Use by task

- Drafting documents and searching and summarizing material are the top 2 tasks
- The average weekly time saved that respondents perceive is longest for writing code and for searching and summarizing material
- Writing code is limited to the IT team and some Design team staff

Task (multiple answers)	Responses	Share of users	Perceived hours saved per week (avg.)
Drafting documents	98	62.4%	1.8
Searching and summarizing material	87	55.4%	2.1
Translation	52	33.1%	1.4
Generating ideas	41	26.1%	0.9
Writing code	14	8.9%	2.6

4.2 Tasks by department

- The Quality team uses it most for searching material such as past defect reports
- The Design team uses it about equally for drafting design change reports and for searching material
- The Sales team uses translation at 58.3% of its users, mainly for overseas customers
- The Production team has too few users to show a pattern by task

Department (users)	Drafting	Searching	Translation	Ideas	Code
Quality team (31)	20	25	8	4	0
Design team (45)	30	28	15	9	9
Production team (19)	6	9	2	3	0
Sales team (24)	16	9	14	10	0
Business Support team (22)	15	8	7	6	0
IT team (5)	3	3	3	2	5
Planning Office (11)	8	5	3	7	0
Total (157)	98	87	52	41	14

5. Compliance with the security rules

5.1 Awareness of the rule

- The current information security rules prohibit entering work documents into external generative AI services
- 201 of 287 respondents (70.0%) said they know this rule
- 86 respondents (30.0%) said they do not know it
- The Production team's awareness rate is 50.0%, far below other departments
- When the rules were revised in 2024, the change was posted only on the company bulletin board and appears not to have reached shop-floor staff

Department	Respondents	Aware of the rule	Awareness rate
Quality team	48	37	77.1%
Design team	62	47	75.8%
Production team	86	43	50.0%
Sales team	34	26	76.5%
Business Support team	39	30	76.9%
IT team	5	5	100.0%
Planning Office	13	13	100.0%
Total	287	201	70.0%

5.2 Work documents entered into external services

- 36 of 157 users (22.9%) said they have entered work documents into an external service
- 4 of them said they entered confidential documents
- 22 of the 36 (61.1%) said they knew the rule
- More of them knew the rule than did not, so guidance alone is unlikely to stop breaches
- The Quality and Sales teams have the highest shares of users who entered documents

Department	Users	Entered documents	Share of users
Quality team	31	9	29.0%
Design team	45	11	24.4%
Production team	19	2	10.5%
Sales team	24	7	29.2%
Business Support team	22	4	18.2%
IT team	5	0	0.0%
Planning Office	11	3	27.3%
Total	157	36	22.9%

5.3 Types of documents entered

- Report drafts and meeting materials were entered most often
- Entering customer and supplier material may breach confidentiality agreements with business partners
- 3 respondents also said they entered documents containing personal information, so a privacy review is needed

Document type entered (multiple answers)	Responses	Share of those who entered documents
Report drafts	21	58.3%
Meeting materials	14	38.9%
Customer and supplier material	9	25.0%
Design and technical documents	8	22.2%
Documents with personal information	3	8.3%

5.4 Reasons for not using it

- 58 of 130 non-users (44.6%) named the security rules as their reason for not using it
- The rules prohibit entering work documents, and use without entering documents is not prohibited
- Some staff appear to read the rules more broadly than they are

Reason for not using	Responses	Share of non-users
Not allowed under the security rules	58	44.6%
Not needed for my work	39	30.0%
Do not know how to use it	33	25.4%

5.5 Views on the rules

- Allowing some use within a defined scope is the most common view at 58.5%
- 18.1% want to keep the current ban, and 14.3% want full use allowed

View	Responses	Share of respondents
Allow some use within a defined scope	168	58.5%
Keep the current ban	52	18.1%
Allow full use	41	14.3%
Not sure	26	9.1%

6. Perceived benefits and errors

6.1 Perceived time saved

- 108 of 157 users (68.8%) said they save 1 hour or more a week
- 37 users (23.6%) said they save 3 hours or more a week
- Time saved is the respondents' own estimate and may differ from measured values

Time saved per week	Responses	Share
Under 1 hour	49	31.2%
1-3 hours	71	45.2%
3-5 hours	28	17.8%
5 hours or more	9	5.7%

6.2 Change in output quality

- 40.8% said the quality of their output improved, and 45.2% said it stayed about the same
- Only 5.7% said quality got worse

Change in output quality	Responses	Share
Better	64	40.8%
About the same	71	45.2%
Worse	9	5.7%
Hard to say	13	8.3%

6.3 Errors

- 112 of 157 users (71.3%) said they have received factually wrong answers
- 17 of them (15.2%) put a wrong answer into a work document without catching it
- Errors in quality reports or customer documents can affect trust outside the company
- Usage guidelines need a step for checking the basis of each answer

7. Concerns and needs

7.1 Concerns

- Answer accuracy and information leaks are the top 2 concerns
- Concern about effects on performance reviews is low at 12.9%

Concern (multiple answers)	Responses	Share of respondents
Answer accuracy	168	58.5%
Information leaks	142	49.5%
Learning to use it	61	21.3%
Effects on performance reviews	37	12.9%

7.2 Support requested from the company

- An in-house service is the top request at 61.3%
- Usage guidelines are also requested by 46.3%, showing strong demand for guidance on what the rules allow

Need (multiple answers)	Responses	Share of respondents
An in-house service	176	61.3%
Training	149	51.9%
Usage guidelines	133	46.3%

7.3 Preferred training format

- Of the 149 respondents who want training, 42.3% prefer hands-on classroom training, the most common choice

Training format	Responses	Share of those wanting training
Hands-on classroom training	63	42.3%
Online video	51	34.2%
Case sharing by department	35	23.5%

8. Open-ended responses

8.1 Tasks staff want to use it for (134 responses)

Category	Responses	Share
Searching past documents	41	30.6%
Drafting reports	33	24.6%
Translating and organizing overseas material	19	14.2%
Looking up shop-floor work standards	16	11.9%
Organizing and analyzing data	15	11.2%
Other	10	7.5%

8.2 What staff want from the company (97 responses)

Category	Responses	Share
An in-house service	38	39.2%
Clearer rules for use	27	27.8%
Training	18	18.6%
Support for paid service costs	9	9.3%
Other	5	5.2%

8.3 Selected responses

- (Quality team) Would like to use it to search past defect reports, but cannot because they cannot be uploaded to external services
- (Quality team) Would like to use it to sort customer complaints by type
- (Design team) Would like to use it to organize design change history and draft change reports
- (Design team) Paper drawings from before 2015 cannot be searched, so they need to be digitized first
- (Production team) Would like to look up work standards on a phone right on the shop floor
- (Production team) Needs a feature that suggests fixes when asked about equipment failure history
- (Sales team) Already uses personal accounts to translate overseas customer emails, so a company-provided service is needed
- (Business Support team) No standard for how far it may be used, so staff use it cautiously
- (Business Support team) Some staff hide their use for fear of breaking the rules
- (IT team) Not enough people to handle integration and operation if a service is introduced
- (Planning Office) A standard for measuring benefits must come first before any investment decision

9. Cases at other companies

- Results of interviews with staff at 3 companies in the same industry (August 2026; company names are pseudonyms)

9.1 Company A (auto parts manufacturer, about 600 staff)

- (Adoption option) A security-contract cloud service under a contract that bars use of input data for training or retention
- (Scope) 3-month pilot for the quality and design teams, then company-wide rollout
- (Measurement) Measured time per past-document search for 2 weeks before the pilot to set a baseline
- (Result) Time per past-document search fell from 42 minutes to 17 minutes, a 59.5% cut
- (Success factor) Measuring the baseline first let it prove the benefit to executives in numbers

9.2 Company B (electronic components manufacturer, about 350 staff)

- (Adoption option) Full use of external general-purpose services allowed without guidelines
- (Course) 6 months later, a customer audit found that customer drawings had been entered into an external service
- (Action) Stopped all use and submitted measures to prevent a recurrence to the customer
- (Lesson) Allowing use without defining its scope and the material that must not be entered puts business relationships directly at risk

9.3 Company C (precision machinery manufacturer, about 900 staff)

- (Adoption option) In-house deployment of an open model on company servers
- (Setup) 9 months to set up, at about KRW 400 million for servers and setup
- (Course) Dissatisfaction with answer quality kept monthly active users at 18% of staff
- (Lesson) Answer quality needs to be checked against real work documents before adoption

9.4 Cases compared

Item	Company A	Company B	Company C
Adoption option	Security-contract cloud	Full use of external general-purpose services	In-house deployment
Pilot	2 teams for 3 months	None	None
Prior measurement	Baseline measured	None	None
Outcome	Company-wide rollout	Use stopped after 6 months	Low use

10. Comparison of adoption options

Item	External general-purpose service	Security-contract cloud	In-house deployment
Handling of input data	May be used to improve the service	Training and retention barred by contract	Kept only on company servers
Fit with the security rules	Breaches the current rules	Allowed with a partial rule change	Allowed under the current rules
Initial cost	None	About KRW 30 million for integration	KRW 300-500 million for servers and setup
Monthly operating cost	About KRW 30,000 per person	KRW 8-12 million a month by usage	About KRW 3 million a month for maintenance
Setup time	Immediate	2-3 months	6-9 months
Answer performance	High	High	Varies widely by model
Operating staff	None needed	Part of 1 IT team member's time	2 or more dedicated staff

- (External general-purpose service) Lowest cost, but it conflicts with the current security rules and carries risks like Company B's

- (Security-contract cloud) Once the contract terms are confirmed, it can be adopted with a partial rule change, and a pilot can start within 2-3 months
- (In-house deployment) Best for security, but initial cost and staffing are heavy, and the 5-person IT team would struggle to run it
- The realistic path is to consider a security-contract cloud first for the pilot and keep in-house deployment as a medium to long-term option

11. Implications and next steps

11.1 Implications

- (Demand) A use rate of 54.7% and 61.3% asking for an in-house service confirm demand for use at work
- (Security) 36 users have entered work documents into external services, and 22 did so knowing the rule
- (Guidelines) 30.0% of staff do not know the rules, and some non-users read them too broadly
- (Gaps) The Production team and managers have little experience of use, so a company-wide rollout needs a separate approach for them
- (Impact) The time savings are only perceived, so a baseline needs to be measured before the pilot, as Company A did
- (Errors) Wrong answers have gone into work documents as they were, so a step for checking the basis of answers is needed

11.2 Next steps

When	What	Owner
October 2026	Draft generative AI usage guidelines and announce them to all staff	Planning Office, Information Security
October 2026	Follow up on cases of confidential documents being entered	Information Security
October 2026	Check contract terms of 2 security-contract cloud providers	IT team
November 2026	Report the in-house hyperscale AI pilot plan (draft) to executives	Planning Office
December 2026	Set training schedules on generative AI use by department	Planning Office, HR

Attachment 1. Survey questions

Respondent profile (all respondents)

- Q1. Department (Quality, Design, Production, Sales, Business Support, IT, Planning Office)
- Q2. Rank (staff, assistant manager, manager, deputy general manager, general manager and above)
- Q3. Age (20s, 30s, 40s, 50 and over)
- Q4. Years of service (under 3 years, 3-10 years, 10 years or more)

Current use

- Q5. Have you used a generative AI service for work in the past 6 months? (all respondents)
- Q6. How often do you use it? (daily, 2-3 times a week, once a week or less)
- Q7. Which services do you mainly use? (multiple answers)
- Q8. Which device do you mainly use it on? (work PC, personal phone, personal PC)

Tasks and benefits (users)

- Q9. Which tasks do you use it for? (multiple answers)
- Q10. How many hours a week do you feel you save on each task?
- Q11. Overall, how many hours a week do you feel you save? (under 1 hour, 1-3 hours, 3-5 hours, 5 hours or more)
- Q12. How has the quality of your output changed since you started using generative AI?
- Q13. Have you received factually wrong answers?
- Q14. Have you used such an answer in a work document without catching it?

Security rules

- Q15. Do you know the rule that prohibits entering work documents into external generative AI services? (all respondents)
- Q16. Have you entered work documents into an external service? (users)
- Q17. What types of documents did you enter? (those who entered documents, multiple answers)
- Q18. Did any of the documents you entered have a confidential classification? (those who entered documents)
- Q19. What is your main reason for not using it? (non-users)
- Q20. What do you think of the current rule? (all respondents)

Concerns and needs (all respondents)

- Q21. What concerns you most about using generative AI at work? (multiple answers)
- Q22. What should the company support? (multiple answers)
- Q23. If you take training, which format do you want? (those wanting training)

Open-ended (all respondents)

- Q24. Write the tasks you would like to use generative AI for.
- Q25. Write what you would like from the company regarding generative AI use.

Attachment 2. Definitions

Term	Definition
Generative AI	An AI service that produces text, images, code and the like in response to a user's questions or instructions
Hyperscale AI	A large AI model trained on large-scale data that can be used across many tasks
User	Staff who used a generative AI service for work at least once in the past 6 months
Security-contract cloud	An external cloud service contracted on terms that bar use of input data for training or retention
In-house deployment	Running an open model on company servers, inside the company network only
Confidential document	A document classified under the information security rules as barred from leaving the company